The Means of Accomplishing the Glorious Hevajra

Śrīhevajrasādhana · Toh 1232 · Derge Tengyur
དཔལ་ཀྱེ་རྡོ་རྗེ་སྒྲུབ་པའི་ཐབས།

The Means of Accomplishing the Glorious Hevajra, known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Hevajra Sādhana and in Tibetan as Pal Kyé Dorjé Drubpé Tap, is a verse sādhana, or deity-practice manual, attributed to the Indian master Ḍombipāda and later translated into Tibetan by the great paṇḍita Vanaratna together with Shönu Pal. Beginning with homage to the glorious Heruka Vajra, it guides the practitioner through the four applications of mindfulness, the arousal of compassion, offerings and refuge, and meditation on emptiness, then through the visualization of the protective tent and palace, the eight goddesses led by Gaurī, and the eight-faced, sixteen-armed Hevajra in union with Nairātmyā. It goes on to the empowerment of the deities, praise, mantra recitation, dedication and aspiration, and the activities between sessions. It is Toh 1232 in the Tengyur, among the Indian commentaries and ritual works on the Buddhist tantras, belonging to the cycle of the Hevajra Tantra.

In the language of India: śrī he bajra sādhana. In the language of Tibet: The Means of Accomplishing the Glorious Hevajra.

Homage to the glorious Heruka Vajra.

Though he has wholly abandoned all conceptualization,
he is the one of great skillful means from whom
comes the intrinsic nature of all things:
to Heruka, the glorious protector, I bow.

On some well-hidden piece of ground,
smeared with musk and the like,
seated upon a soft cushion,
one should cultivate this yoga as follows.

At the heart imagine a lotus born from paṃ,
and a moon born from the letter ā.
There, by the light of the lamp,
one should examine one's own body:
from the feet up to the top of the head
it is filled with excrement, urine and the like.
Examined by dividing it into atoms and so forth,

it has no intrinsic nature.
Having established mindfulness of the body,
feeling too, in its kinds such as pleasure and pain,
one should next examine
as not existing in reality.
Having established mindfulness of feeling,
the mind should be examined in reality:
apart from the body and the rest
there is nothing called "mind."
There is no form of grasped or grasper:
it does not exist; this is the nature of things.
Through mindfulness of mind,
one should examine all phenomena:
the characteristics of the aggregates, elements, sense sources and so on,
these too do not exist in reality.

Having established mindfulness of phenomena,
one should once more bring the mantra to mind.
By its light, radiating from the pores of the body,
one sees all beings without exception,
the destinies of hell beings, hungry ghosts, animals, gods,
asuras and humans,
tormented by birth, aging and death
and by downfalls.
Focusing on great compassion,
as a cause for liberating them,
and in order to increase merit,
one sees the guru, the deities and the victors
together with the hosts of bodhisattvas,
and should thoroughly arrange offerings.

First, the mantra: from the seed in one's own heart
one emanates flowers, incense and the rest.
The mantra is: oṃ bajra puṣpe āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.
Flowers, incense, and likewise lamps,
perfume, and fifth, food;
parasols, victory banners, flags and the like,
garlands and canopies, all well arrayed;

horses, elephants, human women and so on,
all arising from the family of jewels.
All around outside, Gaurī and the others,
holding the five nectars, should be emanated.

One should confess misdeeds,
rejoice in merit,
go for refuge to the Three Jewels,
and contemplate the mind of awakening.
Then first one recites the verse
that is the ultimate support of the path,
the one beginning "To the Three Jewels."

Then, having obtained the command of the Tathāgata,
as the cause of working for the good of sentient beings,
because one is indivisible from all beings,
one takes up great loving-kindness,
generates compassion and joy,
and then cultivates equanimity.
Being free of intrinsic nature, it is emptiness;
being without cause, it is signlessness;
since it is not divided by one's own conceptions,
it is also free of wishing for any destiny.
Then, having seen all as empty,
one should first recite its very mantra.

Then from the syllable hūṃ at the place of the sun
comes forth from the mantra a vajra tent;
one should imagine it reaching the expanse of reality.
And a palace, born from the elements,
square, with four doors,
adorned with necklaces, hanging strips and the like.
There in the center a red lotus
of eight petals should be imagined.
There, resting on its anthers,
the four māras should be imagined.
Brahmā, Indra, Upendra and Rudra,
likewise Yama and Kubera,
Nairṛti and Vemacitrin

are to be imagined well upon the eight petals.

The vowels and consonants become moon and sun; in their center
hūṃ and aṃ should be imagined; by these,
the skull cup and the knife, from one's own seeds,
blessed, are also to be emanated.
Upon this the fivefold manifest awakening
is to be cultivated with the knowledge of yoga.
The mirror-like and equality wisdoms
are well known as the moon and the sun;
the seed and the emblem of the deity
are declared to be the discriminating wisdom;
their becoming one is the accomplishing wisdom;
the completion is the pure nature of reality.
Having emanated and gathered back,
one becomes Vajrasattva oneself,
with emblems, faces and so on as with the son,
with the light of moon, crystal and jewel.
Through joy, the pairs in union
should gather in all the buddhas.
Through the joining of what is churned and the churner,
he abides in the state of great bliss.
In the lotus, from the form of the mind of awakening,
they take the forms of Gaurī and the others.

Then Gaurī, black in color,
holding a curved knife and a fish.
Or else Caurī, the color of madder,
holding a ḍamaru drum and a boar:
imagine her in the south.
Vetālī is placed in the west:
yellow, holding a tortoise vessel,
she is seated in the half cross-legged posture.
Ghasmarī has the light of emerald,
holding a snake, and in her left a vessel.
In the northeast is Pukkasī,
with the light of sapphire, holding a lion,
and in her left hand an axe.

Śabarī is placed in the southeast,
with the light of moon, crystal and jewel,
in her hand a monk's ringed staff.
In the southwest is Caṇḍālī, black,
holding a wheel and a plough.
In the northwest is Ḍombinī, of many colors;
through the purity of the tathāgatas,
with her left hand, together with a vajra,
she makes the threatening gesture: so one should imagine.

By the seeds gaṃ caṃ baṃ gaṃ baṃ śaṃ laṃ
ḍaṃ they are drawn forth,
from the kakkola, in due order,
dancing upon a corpse.
Three-eyed, their hair standing upward,
adorned with garlands of heads like flowers,
the goddesses hold the five mudrās,
with skulls set upon their crowns,
a tiger-skin skirt at the waist,
red eyes and tawny eyebrows.

Having thus visualized the wheel,
the chief together with his consort
melts through great passion,
melting like a vessel of butter.
Seeing that, in their coarse forms as before,
the goddesses of the four corners,
with sweet-sounding songs,
rouse him for the sake of sentient beings:

"Arise, lord, you whose mind is compassion!
Protect me, Pukkasī, completely!
Abandon the nature of emptiness,
and through the union of great bliss, desire me!
Without you I shall die;
Hevajra, arise!"

"Abandoning the very nature of emptiness,
accomplish what Śabarī wishes!

Lord of joy, who cares for the world as for guests,
do you remain in emptiness?"

"Without you I do not know which way to go;
I, Caṇḍālī, make this request:
I know your mind to be illusion;
ah, you master of illusion, arise!"

"I, Ḍombinī, and the town:
do not cut off your compassion!"

From aṃ and hūṃ a curved knife
and a lotus vessel should be imagined.
Having emanated, he rises fully from the melting,
a body in the form of one's own deity,
eight-faced and four-legged,
adorned with sixteen arms,
rich with twenty-four eyes.
The upper face is baring its fangs;
on the right a white face,
and the left one should be visualized as red.
On the crown is a crossed vajra,
and he is adorned with a flower garland of heads.
He bears the five mudrās of the deity,
with a skull set upon the crown.
He is endowed with the sentiments, the erotic and the rest;
his body is black and most terrifying,
adorned with wheel, earrings, necklace,
bracelets and girdle.
Seated upon the backs of the māras,
he threatens gods and asuras,
seated in the dance of the half cross-legged posture.
Embracing him at the shoulder is Nairātmyā,
holding in her left a skull cup and a khaṭvāṅga,
in her right a curved knife,
the most terrifying goddess, black,
with ornaments like her lord's.
Elephant, horse, ass, ox, she-camel,
human, śarabha and cat

are held in eight fearsome skull cups
by the right hands.
Earth, water, wind and fire,
and moon and sun as well,
Antaka (Yama) and Kubera himself
are held in the skull cups of the left hands.
His eyes are red, his eyebrows tawny,
his hair blazing upward.

Then the yogin becomes this himself,
and he subdues all the vicious.
The wisdom wheel, truly,
is summoned, made to enter, bound and brought under control:
by reciting the mantra jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ
one makes it one with one's own wheel.

At the eyes, delusion becomes the Vajrā of Delusion;
at the ears, the Vajrā of Aversion;
at the nose, the Vajrā of Avarice;
at the mouth, the Vajrā of Attachment;
she who is called Jealousy is contemplated at the body;
and at the mind Nairātmyā is placed.
Form is Gaurī, sound is Caurī,
Vetālī is to be declared smell,
Ghasmarī is taste,
touch is to be known as Bhūcarī,
and the element of phenomena becomes Khecarī.
This is the purification of the sense sources.
The aggregate of form becomes Vajrā,
feeling is the White One (Gaurī),
perception is the Water Yoginī,
formations are Vajraḍākinī,
and as the nature of the aggregate of consciousness
Nairātmyā Yoginī abides.
Pukkasī and Śabarī,
Caṇḍālī and Ḍombinī likewise,
in order to purify earth, water, fire and wind,
the yogin should place.

Then the lord of the maṇḍala wheel,
by light radiating from the wisdom seed,
to the buddhas abiding in the sky
makes a request for the sake of empowerment.
Those buddhas, in the form of Heruka,
confer empowerment by the rite.
Gaurī and the others, and Locanā and the others,
the hosts of goddesses, make offerings.
With vases filled with the five nectars,
along with a rain of flowers,
the yogin is empowered.
The crown ornament is by the glorious Mind;
Gaurī and Pukkasī, too,
are to be sealed by the empowerment of Mind itself.
Caurī and Śabarī have the empowerment of Body;
Vetālī has Ratnasambhava;
on Caṇḍālī's crown ornament, the same.
Ḍombinī has the vajra of passion;
Ghasmarī too abides in empowerment.
With the knowledge of yoga one should always meditate.

Then, having made offerings, oneself
should be wholly pleased through praise:
"You, surrounded by the assembly of yoginīs, your companions,
you who have gained the supreme by your own mind,
by whom all beings, moving and unmoving, are made beautiful,
who with a mind of compassion awaken sentient beings,
O Vajra, who brings down the elaborations of illusion,
be pleased, glorious Heruka Vajra!"

Having tasted the nectar,
with the emanating and gathering as before,
with a stable and one-pointed mind
one should perform the mantra recitation thoroughly.
In the moon at the heart of the wisdom being,
the seed becomes a drop and radiates.
When the mantra garland goes outward
it accomplishes the good of all sentient beings.
Gathering it in, the mantra practitioner again

should firmly hold the life wind and the downward-clearing wind.
Having done the recitation, that merit
should be dedicated to sentient beings.

On rising from meditative absorption,
this aspiration should be read:
"Born into the family, keeping the sacred commitments,
with a teacher of Hevajra free from madness,
devoted to a loving guru,
so may I be from birth to birth.
My hands marked by vajra and bell,
reading the profound Dharma,
may I truly drink the fluid of the queen,
birth after birth!"

Then the rites of torma and so on
are for resting, as appropriate.
In the breaks between sessions, likewise,
first make offerings and recite again and again.
At the end of entering the wheel of the heart,
wisdom and skillful means are bliss.
Before being roused by the songs,
having risen by the rite explained,
when one has gained the power to recite,
one undertakes fully the good of sentient beings.

By this, the virtuous and blissful means of accomplishment I have made,
which accomplishes great bliss for all sentient beings without exception,
whatever stainless virtue has been gathered,
by that may beings attain the sky!

The Means of Accomplishing the Glorious Hevajra, composed by Ḍombipāda, is complete. In the presence of the great Dharma king Drakpa Jungné, the great paṇḍita Vanaratna and Shönu Pal translated it in accordance with the commentary of the Kashmiri Silver Vase.

Translator's Notes

• "By the light of the lamp" renders a rare expression, literally "the heat-drinker," taken as a term for a lamp; this is uncertain. "As with the son" (sras bzhin) in the description of

Vajrasattva is obscure as written; it may refer to an earlier described form. The directional placements use the names of the world protectors for the intermediate directions: Īśāna for northeast, fire for southeast, Nairṛti for southwest, wind for northwest. Kakkola is the tantric code term for the consort's secret place.
• "In their coarse forms as before" renders an obscure phrase (sbom po sngon); the sense is uncertain. The line "I, Ḍombinī, and the town" is elliptical in the Tibetan. In the sense-source list the Tibetan reads "Ghasmarī is Vetālī"; this is evidently a slip for "Ghasmarī is in taste," matching the series, and is translated so. "Abiding in the sky" reads mkhar ("fortress") as a slip for mkha'r ("in the sky"). "Mind," "Body" and "Ratnasambhava" in the empowerment section refer to the buddha-family lords who seal each goddess; "Antaka" in the left-hand skull cups is Yama as Death. "The commentary of the Kashmiri Silver Vase" is rendered literally; the work or person meant could not be identified with confidence. "Śarabha" is a mythical eight-legged beast.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.